GGG-S-735B/GEN
October 5, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. GGG-S-735A
October 3, 1974 and
MIL-R-3669C
17 October 1974
(See 6.3)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

STAMPING AND MARKING EQUIPMENT; GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the general requirements for stamping and marking equipment to be used by Government inspectors to designate partial or complete inspection approval. Specific item requirements are covered by the applicable specification sheets (see 6.3).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

NN-H-93	-	Handles: Hickory, Striking-Tool.
QQ-B-613	-	Brass, Leaded and Non-Leaded: Flat Products (Plate, Bar, Sheet and Strip).
QQ-I-666	-	Iron, Malleable, Ferritic, for Castings.
QQ-N-290	-	Nickel Plating (Electrodeposited).
PPP-B-566	-	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665	-	Boxes: Paperboard, Metal Edges and Components.
PPP-B-676	-	Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-121	-	Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 601	-	Rubber: Sampling and Testing.

FSC 5110, 5120,
7520

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(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation-Packaging, Methods of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWING:

US ARMY NATICK RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT COMMAND

6-1-1746 - Rubber Stamps, Fixed and Removable Type, Food Inspection Veterinary. Complete and Partial Approved Inspection Pattern Assemblies.

(Copies of military specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.) (See Supplement 1 for list of associated specification sheets.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

National Bureau of Standards (NBS) Handbook:

H28 - Screw-Thread Standards for Federal Services

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standards:

A 108 - Steel Bars, Carbon, Cold Finished, Standard Quality

A 167 - Stainless and Heat-Resisting Chromium Nickel Steel Plate Sheet and Strip

D 2016 - Moisture Content of Wood

E 18 - Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Material

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Specification sheets. The individual item requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable specification sheets.

3.2 Standard product. The items delivered under this specification shall be the manufacturer's standard commercial product except for any changes necessary to comply with specification requirements.

3.3 Materials. Materials shall be as specified herein. Materials not definitely specified shall be of the quality normally used by the manufacturer in his standard commercial product provided the completed item complies with all provisions of this specification.

3.3.1 Stencil.

3.3.1.1 Brass sheet. The brass sheet for the stencil shall be 1/64-inch thick conforming to QQ-B-613.

3.3.2 Stamps.

3.3.2.1 Wood. The wood shall be close and straight grained hardwood. The moisture content shall be as specified on the applicable specification sheet for the specified type.

3.3.2.2 Rubber. The rubber shall be nitrile-butadiene or neoprene. The durometer reading shall be as specified on the applicable specification sheet for the specified type.

3.3.2.3 Adhesive. The adhesive shall be alcohol resistant.

3.3.2.4 Finish. The finish shall be alcohol resistant.

3.3.2.5 Metal cover and type troughs (veterinary stamp). The metal cover and the type troughs for the removable type shall be corrosion-resistant steel, type 302 of ASTM A 167 or brass in accordance with the manufacturer's standard commercial practice. The configuration shall be as shown on drawing 6-1-1576.

3.3.3 Dies (lumber stamping).

3.3.3.1 Handle. The handle shall conform to the 14 inch claw hammer type of NN-H-93 except it shall have an oval eye end.

3.3.4 Presses.

3.3.4.1 Handles. The press handles shall be malleable iron, grade II of QQ-I-666 or steel in accordance with the manufacturer's standard commercial practice.

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3.3.4.2 Plating. The press handle and frame shall be bright nickel plated conforming to type I of QQ-N-290.

3.3.4.3 Dies. The dies shall be steel in accordance with ASTM A 108.

3.4 Stamping pattern. The stamp patterns for complete and partial inspection shall be sharply cut and in accordance with figure 1, the general dimensions specified, and other data as required herein and on the applicable specification sheets.

3.4.1 Wingspread of eagle and star dimensions. The wingspread of the eagle shown in figure 1 shall not be less than 80 percent of the E dimension (size) and the point to point dimension across the face of the star shall be not less than 5 or no more than 10 percent of the E dimension specified on the applicable specification sheet.

3.4.2 Alpha-numerical designators. When specified (see 6.2), the alpha designator on the left of the stamp impression (eagle's right wing), shown in figure 1, shall represent the applicable DOD department. The alpha designator on the right of the stamp impression (eagle's left wing) shall represent the applicable major command/DCASR. The 4 digit numerical series centered on and positioned under the eagle shall indicate the individual to whom the stamp is assigned. The identifying alpha characteristics assigned to each DOD department is as follows:

(1) Army	-A
(2) Navy	-N
(3) Air Force	-F
(4) DSA	-D
(5) DCAS	-C

3.4.3 Serial numbers. When required (see 6.2), identifying serial numbers shall be applied in accordance with the applicable specification sheets or as otherwise specified.

3.5 Tolerances. Tolerances, not otherwise specified herein or on the specification sheets, shall be within plus or minus 10 percent of the given dimension.

3.6 Finish. The surface characteristics and finish of inspection stencils, stamps, dies and presses shall conform to regular commercial practice.

3.7 Identification marking. Each stencil, stamp, die and press shall be permanently marked with the manufacturer's name or readily identifiable trademark.

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3.8 Workmanship. The workmanship on all inspection stamps and marking equipment shall conform to the quality established herein and on the applicable specification sheets. End items shall be free of surface scale, rust, laps, cracks, fins, burrs or other imperfections which may adversely affect their durability and serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2 Component and material inspection. The supplier shall insure that all components and materials used are manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with referenced specifications and standards unless excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.1 Durometer number of rubber. The durometer hardness of rubber shall be determined by method 3021 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 601 for compliance with the requirements of the applicable specification sheets. The lot shall be all the rubber sheets offered for testing at one time. Any durometer reading not within the specified limits shall constitute failure of the lot.

4.2.2 Change-of-volume of rubber. The change-of-volume shall be tested in accordance with method 6211 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 601 using medium 1 of method 6001 for conformance with the requirements specified in the applicable specification sheets. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of the lot.

4.2.3 Moisture content of wood. Prior to the fabrication of the stamp handle and base, the moisture content of wood requirement in the applicable specification sheets shall be determined in accordance with ASTM D 2016. The lot shall be all pieces of wood required for the fabrication of the stamp handles and bases offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one piece of wood. The inspection level shall be S-1 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units. When testing is performed by the electric moisture meter method, three determinations shall be made on each sample unit. The average of the three determinations shall be the moisture content of the sample unit.

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4.3 End item inspection. A lot shall consist of all like items offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one complete stencil, stamp, die or press.

4.3.1 Visual examination. Examination shall be made for defects in table I. The inspection level shall be level II with an AQL of 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Design	Stamp pattern not sharply cut or legible	X	
	Stamp pattern data incomplete, incorrect or otherwise not as specified	X	
Construction			
Stencil	Stencil not flat		X
	Hole omitted		X
	Burrs or sharp edges		X
Rubber stamp, hand	Handle not firmly attached to base		X
	Handle improperly oriented so as to indicate top of stamp	X	
	Any evidence of non-adherence of rubber stamp or cushion to base	X	
Rubber stamp, veterinary	Handle and base not one piece of wood		X
	Wood front missing	X	
	Nail missing		X
	Pointed end of nails protrude thru stamp base	X	
	Any evidence of non-adherence of rubber stamp or cushion	X	
	Stamp incorrectly oriented or otherwise not as specified	X	

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TABLE I. Classification of defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Construction (cont'd)			
Rubber stamp, pocket	Positive lock for cap missing or not adequate	X	
	Loop for wrist strap or cord missing, not securely attached or inadequate	X	
	Clip not securely attached to or oriented to indicate top of stamp	X	
	Ink pad missing		X
	Any evidence of non-adherence of rubber stamp or cushion	X	
Die, metal, hand	Burrs, sharp edges or corners, slivers	X	
Die, lumber, hammer	Handle loose or not held by wedge		X
Press, hand, reversible and nonreversible	Dies not parallel when handles in closed position	X	
	When applicable, dies not reversible	X	
Workmanship	When applicable, finish incorrect, omitted, incomplete or otherwise not as specified	X	
	Burrs, sharp edges, sharp corners, cracks, slivers or other surface imperfections or malformation		X
Marking	Where applicable, alpha-numerical designators, serial numbers, manufacturer's name or trademark or other marking as specified, omitted, incorrect, illegible, improperly located or otherwise not as specified	X	

4.3.2 Dimensional examination. The stencils, stamps, dies or presses shall be examined for compliance with dimensions specified. Any dimension not within tolerance shall be a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

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4.3.3 End item testing. The stencils, stamps, dies or presses shall be subjected to applicable tests specified in 4.3. Failure to pass any test shall be a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 2.5 defects expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be as listed below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be closed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1, with an AQL of 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Preservation, packaging and packing	Not preserved or packaged as specified. Not level of packaging or packing specified. Box or container not as specified or closed and sealed as required. Quantity per package and pack not as specified.
Marking	Incorrect, missing, incomplete, illegible and not right size.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Stamp finish and glue tests. The stamping surface of the hand, veterinary, or pocket stamp sample shall be immersed a minimum of 1/4-inch in a solution of 40 ± 2 percent absolute ethyl alcohol and 60 ± 2 percent water. The sample shall be removed from the solution and tested as follows:

(1) The finish of the hand or veterinary stamp sample, as applicable, shall be rubbed to determine compliance with the alcohol-resistant finish requirement of the specification sheet. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

(2) The sample hand, veterinary or pocket stamp shall be vertically held by a clamp attached to the handle or body with the rubber pattern facing down. A one-pound weight shall be clamped to and suspended from the edge of the rubber cushion for 30 seconds to determine compliance with the alcohol-resistant adhesive requirements of the specification sheet. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

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4.4.2 Pocket stamp clip test. The clip of the pocket stamp shall be tested by passing a 1/16-inch diameter wire back and forth 200 times under the clip end so as to flex the clip for determination of compliance with the clip flexure requirements of the specification sheet. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure to pass this test.

4.4.3 Die and press hardness tests. Dies and presses shall be tested for Rockwell "C" hardness or Rockwell "N" superficial hardness, as applicable, in accordance with ASTM E 18. The hardness, based on an average of three readings, shall be determined for compliance with the applicable die or stamp requirements of the applicable specification sheet.

4.4.4 Metal stamping die test. The die shall be struck to stamp 25 impressions on a flat alloy steel plate, with a known Rockwell "C" hardness from 40 to 50 checked in accordance with ASTM E 18. Both the impression and the die shall be examined to determine compliance with the stamping requirements of the specification sheet. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure to pass this test.

4.4.5 Lumber stamping die test. The die shall be struck on a flat sample piece of hard pine to make 25 impressions of each end of the die. The impressions and the die shall be examined to determine compliance with the stamping requirements of the specification sheet. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure to pass this test.

4.4.6 Press handle test. The reversible and nonreversible hand presses, as applicable, shall be tested with the jaws blocked to remain open, one handle in a fixed position and an 80-pound load applied on the other handle at a point 1-inch from the end and in the direction to close the die. The load and jaw block shall be removed and the press examined to determine compliance with the handle strength requirements of the applicable specification sheet. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure to pass this test.

4.4.7 Press stamping test. The reversible and nonreversible hand presses, as applicable, shall be tested to impress a sample piece of flat lead strip, 1/8-inch thick $\pm$ 1/32-inch, with one handle in a fixed position and a 60-pound load applied on the other handle at a point 1-inch from the end. The impression made shall be examined to determine compliance with the spring requirements of the applicable specification sheet. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure to pass this test.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Preservation and packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

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5.1.1 Level A. Each item shall be individually preserved and packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-2, except that preservative coatings shall not be applied to rubber and wood components of the rubber stamps.

5.1.2 Level B. Each item shall be individually packaged in boxes conforming to PPP-B-566, variety 1, style II, type D or E, class a; PPP-B-665, style optional; or to PPP-B-676, type optional. The boxes shall be closed in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto.

5.1.3 Level C (commercial package). The item shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supplier to the first receiving activity. The package and quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Like items packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style optional, V3s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V and reinforced as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Like items packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style optional, type CF, variety SW or type SF, class domestic, minimum grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II of the appendix of PPP-B-636. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be V3c, V3s, or V4s, fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix thereto.

5.2.3 Level C. The items packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The quantity per pack shall be that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution. Containers shall comply with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2, as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to special markings required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to special markings required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The stamping and marking equipment covered by this specification are intended for the use of Government inspectors.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification and applicable sheet.
(b) Size and part number of item required, when applicable (see specification sheet).
(c) When required, specify the two alpha characters to be positioned under the left and right wings of the eagle and the four character alpha-numerical series required, e.g., "when stamp impression is viewed, it is to have "C" under the left wing of the eagle and an "A; under the right wing". The four number series under the eagle is to be 0001 through 0009 or; A001 through A999 with the A remaining constant and the numbers progressing through the series specified (see 3.1.2).
(d) Serial numbers, when required (see 3.2.3).
(e) Selection of the level of packaging and the level of packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) When V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard boxes are required for level B (see 5.2.2).
(g) Marking required (see 5.3).

6.2.1 When replacement parts are required for the the reversible or nonreversible lead seal hand presses, specify the following:

(a) The manufacturer's name or trademark from the hand press for which the part is required.

(b) Quantity and the proper name or description of the part required.

(c) Manufacturer's number of the hand press for which the part is required.

6.3 Supersession data. This specification with Federal Specification Sheets GGG-S-735/1 through GGG-S-735/8 supersedes the following specifications:

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Specification		Date
GGG-S-735A	- Stamping and Marking Equipment: Stencils; Rubber Stamps, Fixed Type; Dies, and Presses, Lead Seal	October 3, 1974
MIL-R-3669C	- Rubber Stamps, Fixed and Removeable Type, Food Inspection, Veterinary	17 October 1974

The specification sheet and part number (P/N) applicable to the types, classes and styles in the superseded specifications is as follows:

Superseded specifications	Federal specification sheet and P/N
GGG-S-735A	
Type I - Stencil	GGG-S-735/1
Type II - Rubber stamp, fixed type	
Class 1 - Hand	GGG-S-735/2
Style A - Partial inspection approval	P/N GGGS735-2P
Style B - Complete inspection approval	P/N GGGS735-2C
Class 2 - Pocket style	GGG-S-735/4
Style A - Partial inspection approval	P/N GGGS735-4P
Style B - Complete inspection approval	P/N GGGS735-4C
Type III - Dies	
Class 1 - Metal stamping, hand	GGG-S-735/5
Style A - Partial inspection approval	P/N GGGS735-5P
Style B - Complete inspection approval	P/N GGGS735-5C
Class 2 - Lumber stamping, hammer type	GGG-S-735/6
Type IV - Press, lead seal, hand (reversible)	GGG-S-735/7
Type V - Press, lead seal, hand (nonreversible)	GGG-S-735/8
MIL-R-3669C	GGG-S-735/3
Class A - Partial inspection approval	P/N GGGS735-3P
Class B - Complete inspection approval	P/N GGGS735-3C

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Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 99

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
DSA-CS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

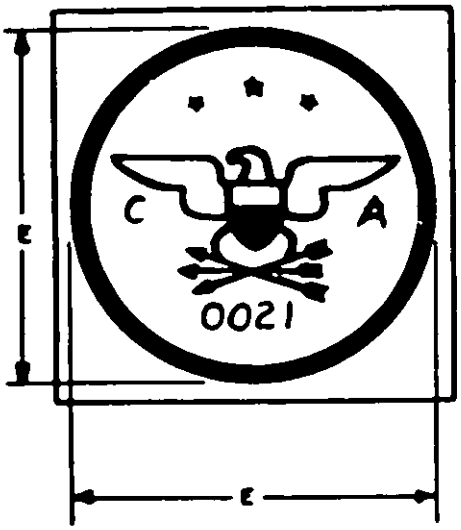
Civil Agency Coordinating Activity:

GSA-FSS

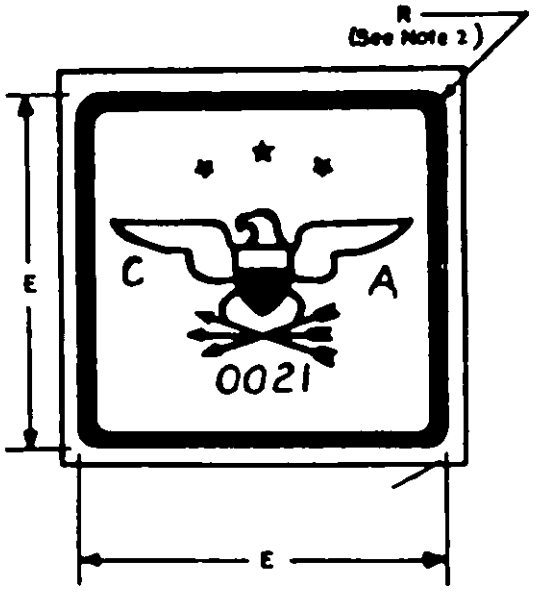
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PARTIAL INSPECTION APPROVAL PATTERN



COMPLETE INSPECTION APPROVAL PATTERN

Example: CA-0021
DCAS–DCASR, Atlanta
Assigned to QA Representative #0021

Note 1: The stamp shall be cut to the opposite hand from the drawing. The stamped impression desired is illustrated.

Note 2: Radius optional.

Note 3: When specified (see 6.1) an alpha characteristic will be positioned as illustrated beneath both the left and right wings of the emblem. The size of the digits shall be at least 10 percent of dimension "E"

Note 4: When note 3 applies, a four digit, alpha-numerical/numerical series shall be centered and positioned as illustrated. The size of the digits shall be at least 10 percent of dimension "E"

INSPECTION APPROVAL PATTERNS
FIGURE 1

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